

Gaming Consoles: New age gaming

A newbie's guide about gaming consoles, and which one fits your requirements.

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A gaming console, essentially, isn't significantly different from a tricked out desktop computer. But with the specific optimisation, game developers know exactly what platform the games are being developed for, which results in the best possible performance getting eked out every single time you play.

There are cons too. Console versions of games are almost never as splendid looking as their PC counterparts, and remember that consoles of today are still off-running GPUs equivalent to the now old GeForce 7800 GTX. Additionally, console titles are typically more expensive than their PC counterparts, and while you can hack your console, patching to latest updates and such becomes a no-no. I know of people who have an Xbox 360 and PS3, combined worth around 50K, and titles worth well over

3 times than amount. Then there is the exclusivity factor – game developers will often develop a title for the PS3 and not on the Xbox 360, or vice versa, and this means that you will at times, not get a title you've been looking for on your console.

Sony PlayStation 3: The PlayStation 3 offers a package that goes well beyond the plain-Jane gaming. Motion Gaming (with the Move controllers), a Blu-ray player and the fact that it plays nice with streaming software like the PS3 Media Server. The PS3 is a device capable of being the gaming console, and the com-

plete entertainment device, in your home entertainment setup.

Speaking of games, the titles available on the PS3 are pretty similar to the ones available on Xbox. However, exclusives like Metal Gear Solid 4, God Of War III and Gran Turismo 5 are what differentiate the PS3 from the Xbox.

The motion gaming capabilities are available on the PS3, with the Move controllers. Available as a separate acces-

sory (₹3.6k), and even as a bundle with a new PS3 should you chose to buy that.

We would recommend you pick up the PS3 Slim (160GB) for about ₹19k. Upgrading the hard drive on the PS3 is an easy task, which you can do at a later date. The complete guide is provided with the user manuals. Add the Blu-ray remote (₹1.5k) to it, if you

will use it a lot for Blu-ray playback or media streaming.

If you have an Xbox, the extra investment on the PS3 isn't really justified, unless you want to play the exclusive game titles. And use the Blu-ray capabilities as well.

If you have a PS3 already, you may not want to upgrade to the PS3 Slim, since the performance gain and the reduced power consumption and heat genera-

tion isn't enough to justify another round of cash drain.

Microsoft Xbox 360: The games available for both the PS3 and the Xbox play equally well on both consoles. The performance difference is negligible, something which most televisions won't even be able to reflect. And most games are available on both platforms. Unless you want to play Halo or Forza Motorsports, that are exclusive to the Xbox platform.

While it is a very capable gaming console, it does not have a Blu-ray drive. Nor is it an excellent media-streaming device. While the PS3 is capable of being the centerpiece of the entertainment setup at home, the Xbox lags behind in that.

Motion gaming (Microsoft Kinect) arrived on this platform, the same time as on the PlayStation 3. The jury is out on whether the Kinect is better, or the PS Move.

Despite the new Xbox 360 (4GB) one hitting the market at ₹14k, we still think that the Xbox 360 with the 250GB hard drive makes more sense, and it costs about ₹21k. Or play ₹31k for the version with the Kinect bundle as a part of the package.

If you already have a PS3, then don't buy the Xbox, unless one (or more) of the exclusive titles entices you.

Nintendo Wii: This is the gaming console that had motion-based gaming available for a long time. The Wii appeals more to the first time gamers, the casual gamers and families as a whole. What the Wii lacks is HD capabilities, high-res graphics and if you like to lazily play games, then

this is for you! The game range is very basic, and some say it is "kiddish" to a certain extent. The graphics are very limited in their appeal.

The Wii console costs about ₹15k, and should be your secondary console. Or buy this if there are very young children at home, since this will be a great way to keep them busy! 



Sony PS3



FIFA 11 on Xbox 360



Forza Motorsport 3